

Curriculum Subcommittee Notes
Via Zoom
5.3.2021

5:01PM Paulette Van der Kloot, Chair

Roll: Paul Ruseau in place of Mea Mustone, Jenny Graham Present

Also Present, Rachel Perry, Peter Cushing, Suzanne Galusi, Bernadette Ricciardelli, Lisa Evangelista, Joan Bowen, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Christine Lee, Medford Community Media, Bill Giglio, Marice Edouard-Vincent, Maureen Lavin

Rachel Perry - Health Education

[Presenting Slides](#)

Medford is aligned to national standards

Revising curricula to match new standards as they are released.

DESE is editing the 1999 frameworks and will put it out for public opinion. Once Medford receives the new state standards, Medford will adjust curriculum again.

Skills based Michigan Model used k-12. (Social/emotional learning curriculum)

Anti-vaping curriculum

- Elementary: Social/emotional taught by classroom teachers
- Lessons start in K on social/emotional learning.
- Third grade: bullying education begins
- 5th grade: Introduction to puberty given by nursing department using proctor and gamble always changing curriculum; PALS program - presented by Medford Police department (replaces DARE program)

Pre and post tests provided to assess student learning

- Middle school Health:

Half year health, half year of guidance in middle school

Catch vaping unit: 6/7/8

6th: drugs, tobacco and alcohol and substances; safety unit, nutrition, wellness, safe internet usage; friendships involving positive and negative risks, conflict resolution and problem solving skills, effects of stress, personal plan for stress management; sexual health (reproductive systems and impact of puberty), teen relationships and sexual decisions

7th: Tobacco free unit (vaping as well), Healthy eating and physical activity unit, safe and sound unit - stress management, nutrition and food labels; sexual health: abstinence, STD types and transmissions, behavioral limits

8th: Drug free unit (internal and external influences); refusal skills, nutrition/physical activity, nutrition information in restaurants and food preparation, nutrition improvement plans; choosing who I am unit (value and character traits for success, positive behavior, stress in middle school). Sexual health: intercourse and reproduction, pregnancy prevention and reproductive health, use of communication skills, use of condoms

Rubrics and pre and post assessments

High School Health: Taught by health teachers
Half year of health/half year of physical education

Freshman year: intro to health
Meaning of health and wellness: creation of vision boards
Mental health (all four years): stress/coping skills/stress management/personal support plan; healthy relationships, lifestyle diseases, abstinence and life monogamy prevent STIs, consent laws, contraception and sexual health, medical testing and advantage of early testing

Sophomore year: healthy decision making
Team building, nutrition and fitness (USDA guidelines/myplate.gov), body image/self image/body function, drugs/alcohol/peer pressure, myths about substances, internal and external pressures and decisionmaking, CATCH curriculum: consequences of vaping

Junior Health: Healthy lifestyles
Stress mgmt, goal setting, advanced nutrition, consumer awareness, resumes and interviewing, deep breathing and muscle relaxation, diet trends and lifestyle changes, eating disorders and prevention.

Senior Health: Transition to adulthood
Sexuality, violence and conflict resolution, mental health, accessing information unit, gender/sexuality unit, gender biases and discrimination, fitness trends, family health history, illness prevention

Rubrics and pre and post tests and projects with the Michigan Model

Paulette Van der Kloot Questions:

Paul Ruseau: I am reviewing the presentation from Feb. 2020 and that presentation was far more granular. Is gender identity covered grades 6 - 8?

Rachel Perry: Covered briefly in grade 6. National guidelines on sexuality/gender identity just changed and we will be adapting to those.

Paul Ruseau: Concerned that it isn't presented until senior year.

Rachel Perry: Also presented freshman year.

Paul Ruseau: Having the right language for consent is important. I heard the pieces but not the word. Kindergartners should learn the concept of consent with touching.

Rachel Perry: Appropriate touch guidelines are introduced.

Paul Ruseau: Is affirmative consent introduced?

Rachel Perry: in middle school

Paul Ruseau: I heard the word abstinence over and over again. Do we ever talk about sex in a positive light?

Rachel Perry: age of consent is 16 so we talk about abstinence to adhere to the law.

Paul Ruseau: Curriculum is designed to make parents not kids happy. Mental health consequences are not good.

Jenny Graham: why do we think this is the best curriculum out there? I am taken aback that we are using a consumer product video on puberty. Have we not progressed beyond this point? I am struggling with this being the best.

Rachel Perry: I want to work with the nursing department about how to improve that lesson. That is not part of the skills based Michigan model. It encompassed everything we were looking for.

Paul Ruseau: Boys videos vs. girls videos?

Rachel Perry: yes

Paul Ruseau: We need to urgently look at that. Boys should not think that menstruation is an abomination.

Paulette Van der Kloot: can we get the link to the video?

Rachel Perry: Yes I can send that. The nurses are presenting the videos.

Suzanne Galusi: In certain situations, the principals work with families when the videos come up. When students are transitioning, they choose which video they relate with.

Paulette Van der Kloot: it would be interesting to see if there is a video to work with all the kids at once.

Paul Ruseau I don't have a problem with separating the kids if that is what works developmentally. I am happy the kids can choose what works for them. The actual video is the issue for me.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Is there an outside presentation on dating violence?

Rachel Perry: Mentors and violence prevention is presented by teachers. Not outside vendors any more.

Physical Education

Elementary: basic skills and concepts

Same units throughout each grade:

Locomotor unit, manipulative skills, cooperative games unit, fitness/dance, yoga

Grades 3 to 5: refining the skills, more game play

Middle school: builds upon the knowledge and skills gained through grade 5

Advance the skill level at each grade level. More on the history and scoring.

Start basic and advance each year.

Two things added recently were dance and yoga to follow national standards.

High School: builds upon elementary and middle school skills

5 components of fitness, personal fitness routines

Water safety and basic swim added recently to freshman year

Juniors and seniors choose what they want to take

- First aid cpr and lifeguard certification.'
- Outdoor pursuits
- Team sports
- Get Fit unit
- Water games
- Yoga (basic through intermediate) - journaling exercise

Assessment: skill/rubrics

Professional development: PE/Health Ed teachers completed CPR certification, first aid, relaxation techniques and self-care

Needs:

Hiring a middle school health teacher

Adaptive PE teacher
Provide sex ed pd
Adaptive PE professional dev for entire PE staff

Due to Pandemic: curriculum adjusted while remote

PE was front loaded with things like fitness and yoga because kids didn't have equipment at home.

Questions;

Paulette Van der Kloot: Adaptive PE; how are we meeting the needs for all students?

Rachel Perry: Some students stay sub separate. Some go into full class.
Flash curriculum (free): looking into expanding use

Jenny Graham: regarding health curriculum, I don't totally understand "we tried michigan model and we liked it" - how was this evaluated? Would it make a difference if we add a middle school health educator

Rachel Perry: It is a skills based model which is what the national standards call for. They used to use Second Step and it was outdated. I looked at what other districts were doing and it was recommended by many other districts.

Paulette Van der Kloot: there was much discussion about looking at our curriculum and assessing the Michigan model. This was thoroughly talked about on the school committee level.

Jenny Graham : Scope and sequence seem very slow. That is my reaction. There are fourth grade girls who get their periods. I don't have a comfort level that we are preparing students as well as we could. I want to make sure that we are being modern in our approach.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Michigan Model is definitely one of the most respected skills based models. We do need to pay attention to the national standards until DESE updates theirs. Girls are hitting puberty at younger ages, especially children of color. Research tells us that we need to emphasize healthy eating - it is the hormones given to vegetables or meat we are feeding our children? Healthy lifestyle is very important because early puberty can lead to weight gain. We are aware of it and need to stay attuned to medical guidance.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Thank you Rachel Perry.
Motion to adjourn: Paul Ruseau/Jenny Graham
Paul Ruseau/Jenny Graham/Paulette Van der Kloot: Motion passes.